National Kitchen Guideline

Objective

The purpose of this guideline is to establish standards operation of Mandir kitchens nationwide. Its aim is to promote consistency in practices, accountability, operational efficiency, and compliance with regulatory requirements.

Teams Involved

The National Kitchen Team will collaborate with Local Kitchen Leads to assist them in regulatory compliance, sourcing, logistics, and effective event planning, while providing reports to Pujya Paramchintan Swami and the Board of Trustees.

Local Kitchen Leads oversee daily operations, coordinate regular Viamrsh meetings with the local team, and cultivate an atmosphere of Samp and Surhadbhav both within their teams and through collaboration with broader local Mandir teams. They are responsible for ensuring compliance with all Guideline requirements and for developing quarterly menu plans, which are reviewed in consultation with Pujya Kothari Sant prior to finalisation.

Mandir Coordinators review and approve purchases, provided these requests fall within their Delegation of Authority (DoA).

Applicable Centres

All BAPS Australia Centres.

Version Control

Version	Date	Author / Owner	Approved by	Summary of Changes
1.0	30/11/2025	National Accounts team	Pujya Paramchintan Swami	Initial Draft

Asset Record Keeping

All major kitchen equipment must be tracked using the asset management app provided by the National Kitchen Team by December 2025. Both existing and new equipment data must be recorded in this app.

For each major item, the following information is required:

- Equipment Location
- Purchase Details (date, supplier, cost, if available)
- Brand and Model
- Serial Number
- Service History (latest service date, if available)

Equipment Maintenance

The Local Kitchen Team lead is responsible for maintaining a maintenance register for all kitchen equipment. This register should be used to track servicing schedules and ensure that equipment is serviced promptly according to manufacturer's recommendation. Keeping accurate records will help prevent unexpected breakdowns and support smooth kitchen operations.

Utensils and Equipment Purchase

- All purchase of large utensils and equipment are to be coordinated with the National Kitchen Team to ensure consistency and operational efficiency across all Mandir kitchens. Local teams are required to submit purchase requests at least 9 months in advance, providing clear and relevant justifications for each item requested.
- Purchase approvals shall be obtained from the local Mandir Coordinator. For purchases that exceed the approval authority of the local Mandir Coordinator, authorisation from the Board of Trustees is required. The National Kitchen Team will facilitate the approval process with the Board of Trustees as needed.

Bulk Orders

- To optimise cost savings and resource efficiency, it is recommended that the most frequently and commonly used disposables, consumables and ingredients such as flour, rice, oil, masala, sweets, farshan and gravy etc are purchased in bulk through the National Kitchen Team.
- The National Kitchen Team will be coordinating and managing the bulk orders and logistics of such orders. In the coming months, a comprehensive bulk ordering process and logistics plan will be shared with each centre. This plan will outline the procedures for placing orders, delivery schedules, and any specific requirements to ensure a smooth and efficient distribution of ingredients to all participating kitchens.

Meetings and Communication

The National Kitchen Team will hold regular Vimarsh sessions with kitchen leads to support collaboration and improvement in Mandir kitchens.

Monthly Kitchen Vimarsh Sessions

The National Kitchen Team will organise monthly Kitchen Vimarsh sessions with kitchen leads. These sessions are designed to provide a platform for discussion, address challenges, share best practices, and review operational updates.

Bi-Annual Conference

In addition to the monthly sessions, a bi-annual conference for all kitchen leads will be held in conjunction with the MSLC. The conference provides an opportunity for strategic planning, professional development, and recognition of excellence within the Mandir kitchen community.

Menu Preparation and Yearly Planning

- Local kitchen lead is required to prepare and submit a comprehensive annual plan outlining all major events scheduled for the year. These plans to include the event menus, procurement strategies, volunteers' allocation, and specific cleaning requirements. This structured approach ensures that all aspects of event management are thoroughly considered and coordinated in advance.
- In addition, a menu covering all events for a period of three to six months will be developed collaboratively. This menu planning process will involve consultation with Pujya Paramchintan Swami to ensure that all culinary offerings align with the expectations and standards of the Mandir.

Menu Planning for National Event

- For the national events such as Shibir, Karcon, and ANMM, the responsibility for menu preparation will rest with the National Kitchen Team. This team will develop tailored menus that cater to the specific requirements and expectations of each event, ensuring consistency and adherence to Mandir standards.
- Once the menu is finalised, the Local Kitchen Team or an appointed team will take charge of all aspects related to the event This includes managing the procurement of required ingredients and materials, as well as overseeing the cooking process.

Samp and Surhadbhav

Samp between Shayona and the local kitchen teams is encouraged, particularly in the context of big samaiya and national events. Such cooperative efforts are essential for ensuring the smooth planning and execution of large-scale gatherings, allowing for the sharing of resources, expertise, and best practices across teams.

Commercial Kitchen Licensing

- All Type A mandirs are required to hold valid commercial kitchen licences at all times. It is essential that the relevant documentation for these licences is stored in a centralised location i.e. OneDrive or Dropbox to ensure easy access and compliance monitoring.
- The National Kitchen Team will assist in setting up and managing a schedule to remind mandirs of upcoming licence renewals to support timely renewals and continuous compliance with regulatory requirements.

Creating a Safe Work Environment

The Local Kitchen Lead ensures a safe and healthy kitchen by monitoring compliance, addressing issues quickly, and promoting ongoing safety awareness.

Donation in Kind

- Local kitchen teams are encouraged to seek donations in kind to support ongoing operation of their kitchen. Donation drives should be scheduled ahead of Diwali and any major external Samaiya.
- It is important for the local team to maintain a record of all donors and to nurture ongoing relationships by recognising their support during events and distributing prasad as a gesture of appreciation. After each event, the local team to send a letter of appreciation to all donors.
- The National Kitchen Team will provide support throughout these donation drives by conducting regular meetings with the designated donation in kind lead to ensure coordination and effectiveness.

Expense Re-imbursement

- All reimbursement claims must be submitted within 14 days of the purchase date. Timely submission ensures efficient processing and accurate record-keeping.
- It is the responsibility of each local team to ensure that all members adhere strictly to the established reimbursement process.